Ben Gong

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EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley Expected August 2030

Bachelor of Science, Haas School of Business, Global Management Program (GMP). Intended double major in Computer Science

Relevant Coursework: CS 70: Discrete Mathematics and Probability Theory, CS 61A: Structure and Interpretation of Computer Programs, MATH 51 & 52: Calculus I & II, STAT 2: Introduction to Statistics, ECON 1: Introduction to Economics.

Honors & Awards:

AMC 12B: AIME Qualification & Certificate of Distinction 2024

Scored 111 (top 2.5% of all contest takers).

World Youth Go Championships: U18 Division, Top 8 Finish 2023

Selected by the Canadian Go Association to represent Canada; competed in 6 rounds against country representatives worldwide; trained with world-class professional players.

WORK EXPERIENCE

OpenMind Berkeley, CA

Contract Product Manager September 2026–Present

- Identified high-value enterprise use cases in manufacturing and retail, evaluating product-market fit for OpenMind's platform.
- Segmented 50+ enterprise accounts and developed 5 buyer personas to prioritize target customers by adoption potential and strategic fit.
- Conducted outreach to 100+ prospective customers, validating enterprise demand and building a data-driven go-to-market strategy.

Lotus Foods Berkeley, CA

Associate Consultant September 2026–Present

- Conducted market research on Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR) packaging regulations across targeted states.
- Built an AI-driven spreadsheet tool that improved the efficiency and accuracy of navigating state EPR requirements for the sales team.
- Developed a full compliance solution plan by modeling hypothetical sales scenarios in the tool and analyzing the resulting obligations.

Office of Randeep Sarai, MP Surrey, BC

Contract Web Developer March 2025–April 2025

- Hired on a paid contract to build and run the Surrey-Newton MP's official campaign website end to end, from requirements to launch.
- Developed the backend for volunteer sign-ups, event RSVPs, and contact forms, storing supporter data and routing it to campaign staff.
- Managed hosting, domain, SSL, and deployments; ran ongoing maintenance and coordinated content updates and timelines with staff.

Canadian Go Association Canada

Youth Ambassador & Marketing Lead 2021–Present

- Started and managed the association's official Rednote account (800+ followers).
- Organized regional tournaments and raised $1,000+ to import 325 Go boards for the association.
- Managed bookkeeping and served as MC for the World Amateur Go Championships in Vancouver.
- Supported the association's transition to a new software platform by transferring user data and providing interface feedback.

PROJECTS

PolyMind Berkeley, CA

Creator & Developer September 2026–Present

- Built a Python game engine simulating The Battle of Polytopia's turn-based rules (tech tree, cities, combat, resources, buildings) for all 12 tribes, with versioned, frozen rule sets and 313 automated tests.
- Trained generations of PyTorch agents (Legion and Alpha families) via self-play reinforcement learning, each with a policy network and win-prediction value head, combined with lookahead search at play time; ran controlled reward-variant pilots on cloud compute.
- Built an Elo-based evaluation pipeline to select deployments; shipped a web app where users play 5 AI opponents in-browser.

GoGlobal Surrey, BC

Founder & Website Developer August 2024–Present

- Founded an international youth-led online Go community offering free classes and resources; partnered with the Canadian Go Association and Canada West Go Association.
- Designed website and class curricula, managed 45+ volunteer teachers, and provided 500+ hours of lessons for students.
- Trained a local AI model to play Go at a beginner level; presented findings on training methods and analyzed how AI comprehends Go.

Fraguessr Berkeley, CA

Creator & Full-Stack Developer September 2026–Present

- Developed fraguessr.com, a daily perfume-guessing web game where players identify a famous fragrance's notes on an interactive 3D globe mapping 354 ingredients from 116 countries to 602 fragrances from 198 perfume houses.
- Built a Firebase backend for accounts, cross-device sync, live multiplayer rooms, and Elo-ranked matchmaking with AI opponents.
- Designed engagement systems (daily streaks, rewards, leveling, and 1,770 researched, source-verified collectible facts).

Innocommunity Surrey, BC

Founder & Community Programs Director 2022–Present

- Founded a nonprofit supporting immigrant-owned businesses in the community.
- Grew social media accounts to a combined 8,000 followers to help 35+ businesses with digital marketing and online presence.
- Presented market research and outreach plans to business owners and designed digital and physical marketing products.
- Generated 600+ leads and $31,000+ in combined revenue for partner businesses; created a customer network for collaborative projects.

SKILLS

Software: Python, Java, C++, SQL, JavaScript, Social Media Management (Rednote, Instagram), Web Design, Canva, Microsoft Excel.

Language: English (Fluent), Mandarin Chinese (Fluent), French (Intermediate).

Interests: Tennis, Fragrances, Antique Coins, Go (Weiqi), Jazz.